Urban Beekeeping: A Short Guide

Keeping bees in a city is legal in most places and needs little space.

A single hive fits on a rooftop or a balcony of about two square metres.

City bees often find more varied flowers than bees in farmland.

This guide covers setup, seasonal care, and honey harvesting.

1. Setting Up a Hive

Choose a spot with morning sun and shelter from strong wind.

Face the entrance away from busy paths so bees fly above head height.

A starter colony of about ten thousand bees costs roughly 150 dollars.

Provide a shallow water source within ten metres of the hive.

2. Seasonal Care

Spring: inspect weekly and add space before the colony outgrows the box.

Summer: watch for swarming signs such as new queen cells.

Autumn: reduce the entrance and feed sugar syrup if stores are low.

Winter: leave the colony alone and only check that the hive is dry.

3. Harvesting Honey

A healthy hive yields about 15 kilograms of honey in a good year.

Harvest only capped honey, and always leave enough for the winter.

Strain the honey through a fine mesh and store it in clean sealed jars.

Results: 80 percent of new keepers reported a successful first harvest.